EXPERIMENT – 17
CHANGE HARDWARE COMPATIBILITY OF A VIRTUAL MACHINE

AIM

To change the hardware compatibility level of an existing or cloned virtual machine in VMware Workstation and to check that the virtual machine still runs properly.

REQUIREMENTS

1. A computer running the Windows operating system.
2. VMware Workstation installed on the computer.
3. An existing or cloned virtual machine, which should be powered off.
4. An internet connection, and the guest operating system ISO file where it is required.

PROCEDURE

1. Open VMware Workstation and select a virtual machine. Shut it down so that it is powered off.
2. Create a backup copy or a clone of the virtual machine before changing the compatibility settings.
3. Open the VM menu and choose Manage → Change Hardware Compatibility (this option is available only in some versions).
4. Read the information on the first page of the Change Hardware Compatibility Wizard and click Next.
5. Choose whether to alter this virtual machine or to create a clone of it with the new compatibility, and click Next.
6. From the drop-down list of hardware compatibility versions (for example Workstation 15.x or ESXi 7.0), select the version supported by the installed VMware Workstation and by the host where the VM will be used.
7. Review the compatibility change and complete the wizard.
8. Wait for the conversion to finish and do not interrupt the process.
9. Open the virtual machine details and check the new compatibility level.
10. Power on the virtual machine and check that the guest operating system starts correctly.
11. Note down the selected compatibility level and the result of the boot test.

IMPLEMENTATION INPUT

A powered-off VMware virtual machine. A backup or clone is recommended before changing the compatibility.

OUTPUT

The screenshot shows the Change Hardware Compatibility Wizard with the list of available hardware compatibility versions.

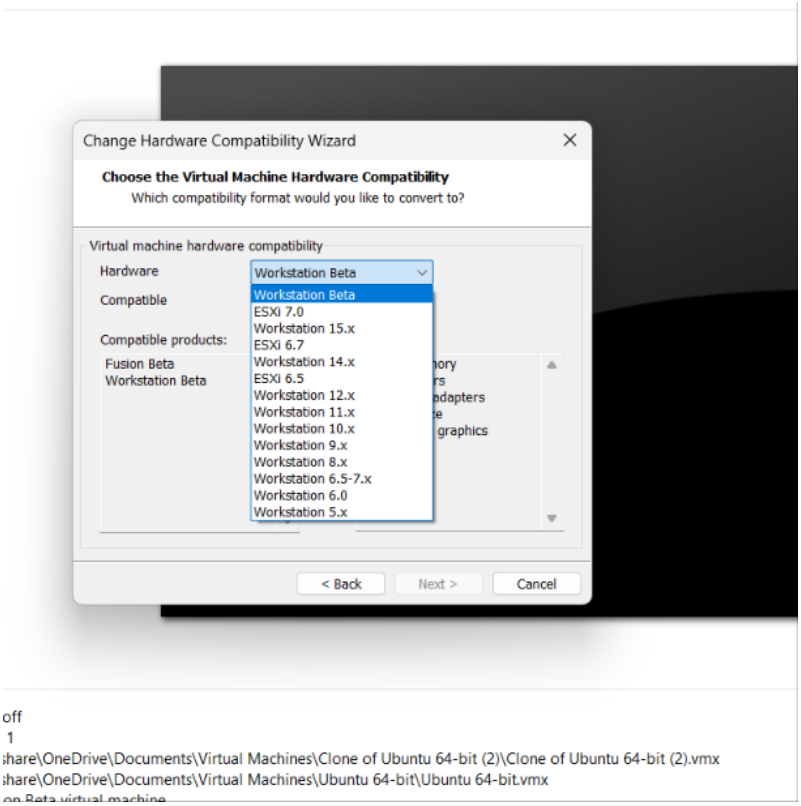


Figure 1: Change Hardware Compatibility Wizard in VMware Workstation, showing the compatibility versions from Workstation Beta down to Workstation 5.x.

RESULT

Thus, the hardware compatibility of the virtual machine was changed and the virtual machine was tested for successful operation.